

Project "QUAHOG": Master Plan & Development Timeline

This Master Plan establishes a structured path to translate the core creative vision and technical specifications into a functional open-world crime epic.

Development strictly adheres to the tonal guidelines, gameplay systems, and regional mechanics detailed in **GTA-South-Coast-Pitch.pdf** and **GTA-South-Coast-GDD.md**, utilizing the visual layout reference established in **gta-south-coast.html**.



Phase 1: Core Engine & Data Backbone (Weeks 1–4)

Focus: Establish the central logic, state management, and persistence layer.

- **Step 1.1:** Implement the PlayerWallet singleton and database relational schema using the architecture outlined in **Copy of GTA South Coast Architecture .pdf**.
- **Step 1.2:** Initialize the local SQLite persistence layer (EmpireDatabaseManager) to track global player metrics, balances, and real-time asset ownership.
- **Step 1.3:** Build the dynamic WeatherController state machine to tie environmental shifting (Clear, Dense Fog, Coastal Rain, Nor'easter) directly to surface friction multipliers.



Phase 2: Macro World & Basic Interactivity (Weeks 5–10)

Focus: Graybox environment mapping, traversal mechanics, and property acquisition hooks.

- **Step 2.1:** Generate the structural open-world graybox map boundaries, establishing the four core districts (Cascade, New Sefton, Cape Cobb, Brockmore) split by structural canal bridges as diagrammed in **GTA-South-Coast-Pitch.pdf**.
- **Step 2.2:** Deploy baseline vehicle physics listeners that automatically inherit weather modification scalars (handling slick cobblestones, flooded docks, and bridge slush).
- **Step 2.3:** Place interaction vectors (markers) across the map for the 5 fundamental businesses listed in the portfolio of **gta-south-coast.html**, linking them to the AcquisitionEngine.



Phase 3: Secondary Subsystems & Soundscapes (Weeks 11–14)

Focus: In-game economy ticking, reward inventories, and atmospheric integration.

- **Step 3.1:** Implement the RevenueManager time loop to trigger automatic daily asset yield distributions or manage dynamic margin-leak events.
- **Step 3.2:** Build out the ChopShopArmsManager scriptable object profile, bridging weapon crate availability directly to the upgrade progression tier of *Quequechan Mill #4*.
- **Step 3.3:** Integrate the multi-channel background audio system (RadioManager) to

stream simultaneous, crossfading audio tracks replicating the localized stations detailed in **GTA-South-Coast-GDD.md**.

Phase 4: Scripted Progression & Vertical Slice **(Weeks 15–18)**

Focus: Mission state tracking, UI scripting, and full loop verification.

- **Step 4.1:** Launch the MissionManager objective engine to coordinate multi-step scripted scenarios, tracking player location, target statuses, and rewards.
- **Step 4.2:** Code the debut vertical slice mission loop: Vinny's initial arrival, the New Sefton fish pier ambush sequence, a high-speed coastal fog getaway, and initial safehouse validation.

Master Plan, taking us from the end of Phase 4 all the way to the Alpha build, heavily referencing the unique flavor of the South Coast.

Phase 5: The Living City & AI (Weeks 19–24)

Focus: Crowds, traffic splines, and ambient world reactivity.

** **Step 5.1: Traffic Splines & Vehicle Spawning:** Lay down the road network logic. Ensure regional vehicle spawning is accurate—e.g., rusted "Townie" sedans and "Linguiça" mopeds spawn heavily in Cascade, while "Codfish 40" cruisers and preppy imports only spawn across the canal in Cape Cobb.*

** **Step 5.2: Pedestrian State Machine:** Build the civilian AI. Pedestrians need states for idling, walking, fleeing, and reacting to weather (e.g., putting up umbrellas or running for cover when the WeatherController triggers a Nor'easter).*

** **Step 5.3: Turf & Territory Bounds:** Map out the faction zones. Assign the Azorean Syndicate to the Flint and the Crioulo Crews to New Sefton's South End, dictating which NPC models and lowriders spawn in those zip codes.*

Phase 6: Combat, Consequences & "Heat" (Weeks 25–29)

Focus: Weapons, the Wanted system, and faction hostility.

** **Step 6.1: The Dual-Axis Hostility Manager:** Implement the core "Wanted" level. Axis A tracks local Law Enforcement (1 to 5 badges). Axis B tracks Faction Aggro—if you shoot up a Provençal gambling room in a dead mill, their hit squads will spawn to hunt you in that territory.*

** **Step 6.2: Combat & Weapon Feel:** Implement the player aiming controller, cover system, and weapon ballistics. Ensure heavy weapons (like those from the Quequechan Mill chop shop) feel distinctly different from starter pistols.*

** **Step 6.3: Safehouses & Evading:** Build the logic for losing "Heat." Enable the purchase of safehouses, such as the notorious "Maplecroft" axe-murder B&B in the Highlands, where Vinny can sleep to clear his wanted level and save the game.*

Phase 7: Voice, Dialect & "The Sidelines" (Weeks

30–35)

Focus: Narrative implementation, side-quests, and the crucial local audio.

* **Step 7.1: The Dialect Engine (Audio Implementation):** Integrate the voice lines, ensuring the Eastern New England non-rhotic accent ("pahk the cah") is applied to ambient NPC barks. Implement the specific audio triggers for characters like Chip Worthington III and his performative "hard Rs".

* **Step 7.2: Radio Host Integration:** Hook up the dynamic DJ chatter for Buddy Mello screaming about bridge traffic on *The Rage* and Iron Mike Fontaine on *The Anvil* so they react to story milestones.

* **Step 7.3: The "Sidelines" Story Threads:** Script the complex optional side-missions. Build the logic for "The Undeclared" boxing thread at Champion City Gym in Brockmore, and "Acquitted," the Bordon legacy missions in Cascade.

Phase 8: UI, Polish & The Coastal Vibe (Weeks 36–42)

Focus: Player interface, visual fidelity, and dynamic events.

* **Step 8.1: HUD & Radar:** Build the mini-map. It must track the player's rotation, display property icons, highlight hostile faction blips in red, and show the sweeps of the local lighthouses.

* **Step 8.2: "Coastal Neon" Rendering:** Finalize the post-processing stack. Ensure the flickering tavern signs reflect properly off rain-slicked cobblestones and oily dock water, and verify the lime-green glow of the Verde Bridge works in the fog.

* **Step 8.3: The "Gloria" Event:** Script the mid-game hurricane set-piece (homage to the '85 storm) that temporarily floods low roads, alters the map, and sinks boats.

With this complete roadmap, we have a clear trajectory from a blank engine project to a fully functioning open world.